



PEOPLE OPERATIONS · PROCESS

Contingent Worker Process Guide

Track 1, start to finish: requesting an agency temp,
onboarding, timesheets, changes and ending an assignment.



Contingent Worker Process Guide

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Audience

Hiring managers, HR and Finance

Classification

Internal use only

Overview and When to Use One

A contingent worker is employed by a staffing agency and assigned to us for a period of time. We pay by the hour, we direct their day-to-day work, and the agency stays their employer throughout.

Use Track 1 when:

- you need an extra pair of hands doing work we already understand
- the work is ongoing rather than a discrete deliverable
- you will be setting their priorities day to day
- you need them working our hours, often on our systems and equipment
- you are covering a gap — parental leave, a vacancy, a busy season

Use Track 2 instead when you have agreed a deliverable and a price, and how it gets built is up to them. See the Contractor Process Guide.

The four-party relationship. Track 1 has more moving parts than ordinary employment, and most confusion comes from forgetting who is who:

Party	Role
The worker	Does the work
The agency	Employs them — pay, benefits, discipline, employment decisions
The hiring manager	Directs the work, approves hours, owns the assignment
HR	Owens the agency relationship, the rates and the process

What this means in practice. You tell the worker what to do; you do not tell them what they earn. You decide the assignment should end; the agency tells them. You give feedback; the agency runs the review. Getting this split wrong is the co-employment risk described in the handbook.

Typical length. Most assignments run three to six months. Anything heading past twelve months gets reviewed by HR, who will ask whether this is really a permanent job.

Raising a Request

Before you raise anything, confirm you are in Track 1 — see Choosing the Right Track in the handbook — and check you have budget. Finance will ask.

Raise the request in Beeline: Requests → New Worker Request. You will need:

Field	Notes
Job title	Use the closest match from the list; HR adds new titles on request

Field	Notes
What they will do	A few sentences on the actual work, not a generic description
Must-have skills	Three to five. Long lists slow the agency down and rarely improve the shortlist
Start date	Allow at least two weeks from approval
Expected end date	An honest estimate; extensions are straightforward
Hours per week	And the working pattern, if it matters
Location	Office, hybrid or remote — and if remote, which state
Budget and cost centre	The total you expect to commit
Manager	Who directs the work day to day, if not you

What happens next

- 1. Approval** — your manager approves in Beeline, or the department head and Finance if the total is over \$25,000.
- 2. HR reviews** the request, confirms the classification and the rate, and sends it to one or two agencies. Usually the same day.
- 3. The agency sources** and sends candidates back through Beeline. Expect a first shortlist within three to five working days.
- 4. You review and choose** — see Choosing a Candidate.
- 5. The agency confirms** the assignment in Beeline, and onboarding starts.

Realistic timeline: about two to three weeks from raising the request to someone starting, of which onboarding is the last five working days. Urgent needs can move faster — tell HR rather than shortening the description.

A few things that make this go badly. Approaching an agency yourself; agreeing a rate directly; naming someone you already know without telling HR (there is a process for that — see Choosing a Candidate); or writing a job description so broad that the agency guesses. All of these cost more time than they save.

Choosing a Candidate

Candidates come back through Beeline with a CV, an availability date and the agency's proposed rate. Everything runs through the system — if an agency emails you a CV directly, forward it to HR rather than replying.

Reviewing. Open the request in Beeline and go to the Candidates tab. You can compare candidates side by side, including rate. HR filters out anyone who does not meet the must-haves, so what you see has already been through a first pass. If you want to see everything that came in, ask HR.

Interviewing. Most contingent assignments need one conversation, thirty minutes, usually by video. Some do not need one at all — a straightforward assignment against a clear description can go straight to selection.

To set one up, ask in Beeline or email HR with the candidate's name and a couple of times that work. HR arranges it with the agency. Keep in mind:

- Interview for the work, not for cultural fit in the way you would for a permanent hire. This is an assignment, not a career.
- Ask the same questions of each candidate.
- Do not discuss pay, rates or the possibility of a permanent job.
- Send HR a short note afterwards, whether yes or no. The agency needs the feedback and so does the next search.

Choosing. Tell HR the name and the start date you want. HR confirms with the agency, the agency accepts the assignment in Beeline, and onboarding begins.

Someone you already know. If you have a specific person in mind — a former colleague, someone who has worked with us before, a referral — say so at the request stage rather than lining it up yourself. HR will place them through one of our agencies so the employment relationship sits in the right place. This is common and perfectly fine; it just cannot be arranged privately.

Relatives. Nobody may take an assignment reporting into a relative, or into a team a relative manages. Declare it to HR if it comes up.

Onboarding Checklist

Onboarding takes about five working days. It starts when the agency accepts the assignment in Beeline and ends on the worker's first morning.

The agency handles the employment paperwork, right-to-work verification and any background check the role needs. They confirm in Beeline when this is done. The assignment cannot start before that confirmation — not even informally, and not for a day or two while we wait.

HR handles the BambooHR record, which is what triggers everything else, and confirms the confidentiality agreement is in place.

IT handles the account, the access level and the equipment, working from the BambooHR record. Give them five working days.

You handle the practical side of someone joining a team.

Your checklist

Before day one:

- Raise the IT request: account, access level, equipment, and a desk or site access if they are coming in
- Decide what they actually need access to — narrowest that works
- Put the first week in the calendar: who they meet, what they will start on

- Tell the team who is joining, for how long, and what they will be doing
- Confirm start time and where to go, and send it to them through the agency

On day one:

- Meet them yourself, or arrange for someone specific to
- Walk them through the work, the tools and who to ask
- Cover the safety essentials for the site if they are on one
- Check their account and equipment actually work
- Set their email signature: name, role, agency, and "on assignment at Helvia"

In week one:

- Confirm they have submitted their first timesheet correctly
- Agree a regular check-in
- Flag anything that is not working to HR early

Background checks. The role decides the level, and HR sets it when the request is approved. Standard office roles get an identity and right-to-work check. Roles with access to customer data, finances or a site get a fuller check. The worker can start once the agency confirms the check is complete.

What not to do. Do not hand over a laptop that was not issued through IT, do not give access by sharing your own credentials, and do not let someone start before the agency has confirmed. Each of these is the kind of shortcut that is invisible until it is not.

Timesheets and Approval

Contingent workers are paid for the hours they work, so the timesheet is what triggers payment to the agency. Approving one is an authorisation to pay.

The weekly cycle

When	What
Monday to Sunday	The working week
Sunday, end of day	The worker submits their timesheet in Beeline
Monday, 5 p.m.	You approve or reject it
Tuesday	Beeline generates the agency invoice

Approving. Beeline emails you when a timesheet is waiting. Approve it from the email, or in Beeline under Approvals → Timesheets where you can do several at once.

Before you approve, check the total hours look right, overtime is genuinely overtime you knew about, and the days match what actually happened. Approving without looking is how we end up paying for hours

nobody worked — and it is your budget.

Rejecting. Reject it with a short reason. The worker corrects it and resubmits, and you will see it again the same day or the next. Rejecting is not a big deal; talk to them first so they know why.

Overtime. Anything beyond 40 hours in a week needs to have been agreed with you in advance. If overtime appears on a timesheet you did not approve, reject it and talk to the worker and the agency. In California and Colorado daily overtime rules apply as well — see Overtime, Double Time and Comp Time.

Missing the deadline delays the agency invoice and the worker's pay. They are being paid by the hour and often on a weekly cycle, so a late approval lands on a real person. HR chases anything outstanding on Tuesday.

When you are away. Set a delegate in Beeline before you go — Settings → Delegates. Your delegate can approve timesheets on your behalf. Do not leave approvals to pile up for a week.

Expenses. Where the assignment involves agreed expenses, they go on an expense claim in Beeline with a receipt attached, on the same weekly cycle. See Travel and Expenses for what can be claimed.

Comp time is not allowed. You cannot give a contingent worker time off in lieu of paying overtime. Every hour worked is recorded and paid in the week it was worked.

Day-to-Day Management

Day to day, a contingent worker is a member of your team for the purposes of getting work done, and an employee of someone else for everything to do with employment. Both halves are true at once.

Normal and expected:

- setting their priorities and reviewing their work
- including them in stand-ups, team meetings, project rituals and anything about the work
- giving them the tools, access and context they need
- giving feedback directly, including when something is not working
- agreeing their working pattern and when they take time off
- including them socially — team lunches, an occasional after-work thing

Not ours to do:

- discussing pay, rates, bonuses or raises
- running a formal performance review
- disciplining them, or dismissing them
- handling their leave, sickness absence or benefits
- promising them a permanent role
- including them in employee-only sessions: company results, strategy, all-hands

Time off. Agree it with them as you would with anyone, and tell the agency — they manage the entitlement and the pay. Sickness goes to the agency too; you just need to know they are not coming in.

If something is wrong. Raise it with them directly first, the way you would with anyone. If it does not improve, tell HR — do not escalate to the agency yourself. HR will involve the agency, and the conversation with the worker is the agency's to have.

If they raise something with you — about their pay, their contract, their treatment by the agency — listen, do not try to fix it, and point them to their agency contact. Tell HR the same day if it sounds serious. A concern about safety, harassment or discrimination comes to HR immediately regardless of who employs them.

Site closures. Do not have an external worker on site when we are closed, unless there is a real business reason and a Helvia manager is there too.

Check-ins and Performance

We check in on assignments to catch problems early and to make sure we are still getting what we need. This is not a performance review — those belong to the agency — but the feedback does reach them.

The cadence

When	What
30 days in	First check-in. Is this working, for us and for them?
Every 6 months	A short review while the assignment continues
At the end	Closing feedback, which shapes whether we would take them again

Beeline sends you a short form at each point. It takes a few minutes, and HR follows up if it sits unanswered for more than ten working days.

What to cover at 30 days

- Are they doing the work we expected, at the standard we expected?
- Is the scope still what we described, or has it drifted?
- Do they have the access, tools and context they need?
- Is the time commitment right — are they under-used, or quietly doing overtime?
- From their side: is anything getting in the way?

Giving feedback well. Give it to the person directly and continuously — that is ordinary management and it is entirely appropriate. Put the substance into the check-in form too, because that is what reaches the agency and it is what they use in their own review. Be specific: "picked up our deployment process in a week and is now running releases unsupervised" is worth more to everyone than "doing well".

When it is not working. Say so early, to them and to HR. Most problems at the 30-day mark are fixable — unclear scope, missing access, a mismatch between the description and the reality. If it is genuinely not working, HR will arrange a replacement with the agency; that is one of the things we pay an agency for. Do not let a poor fit drift for months because the conversation is awkward.

The twelve-month question. When an assignment approaches a year, HR will ask you directly: is this a temporary need or a permanent job? If it is a job, the right answer is usually to hire — see Converting to an Employee.

Extending or Changing an Assignment

Extending an assignment

Most assignments get extended at least once. Raise it in Beeline — open the assignment and choose Extend — at least two weeks before the current end date. You will need the new end date and confirmation that the budget covers it.

It routes to the same approvers as the original request, and to the department head and Finance if the extension pushes total committed spend over \$25,000. HR confirms with the agency, and the rate normally carries over unchanged.

Give notice. Two weeks is the minimum because the agency has to confirm the worker is available. A worker whose assignment appears to be ending will start looking at other placements, and last-minute extensions are how we lose people we wanted to keep.

Changing the work

If what the person is doing has changed materially — a different role, a significantly different skill set, a different team — that is not an extension. Tell HR, because the rate and the classification may both need to change, and a substantial change of scope sometimes means a new request.

Smaller changes you can make in Beeline against the assignment:

Change	How
End date	Extend, as above
Hiring manager	Change Manager on the assignment — do this the day it happens, or approvals go to the wrong person
Cost centre	Change Cost Centre; tell Finance if it crosses budgets
Hours per week	Change Hours; a material change needs the agency to agree
Location, including a move to remote	Change Location, and see the Flexible Work Policy

Changing manager matters more than it looks. Timesheet approvals, check-in forms and end-of-assignment notifications all follow the manager field. An assignment pointing at someone who has left is a set of approvals nobody is doing.

What you cannot change without going back to HR: the bill rate, the agency, or the worker. Moving someone to a different agency mid-assignment is not possible — if a worker changes agency, the assignment with us ends.

Tracking. Every change request shows its status in Beeline under My Requests. Most are confirmed within two working days.

Ending an Assignment

Assignments end in one of three ways. The first is ordinary and you can run it yourself; the other two go through HR.

1. Planned end — the end date arrives, the project finishes, or the worker gives notice.

Tell HR and close the assignment in Beeline, giving the end date and the reason. Aim for a week's notice so the agency can line up their next placement. The last day happens normally, on site, during working hours.

2. Early end — the assignment is not working: performance, reliability, attitude, or a change in our needs.

Tell HR with the reason before you tell anyone else. HR reviews it, involves the agency, and the agency speaks to the worker. Give at least 24 hours so this can be coordinated. The conversation is the agency's to have, not yours — we end the assignment, they handle the employment.

3. Immediate end — a serious safety breach, threatening behaviour, theft, or a serious breach of our policies.

Call HR straight away. Ask the person to stop work and leave. Email it@helvia.ai to cut access immediately, and copy HR. Do not attempt to handle a confrontation alone — if anyone is at risk, call emergency services first.

The offboarding checklist — yours, in all three cases:

- Close the assignment in Beeline with the end date and reason
- Email it@helvia.ai to remove accounts and access on the last day
- Collect the laptop, any other equipment, keys and access card. If they are remote, ask HR to arrange a return label
- Make sure their work is handed over: documents in our systems, code merged, access to anything only they can reach passed on
- Complete the closing check-in form in Beeline
- Approve their final timesheet and any outstanding expenses

HR will confirm the end date with the agency, update BambooHR, and check the offboarding items are done.

Two things to remember. We do not terminate anyone's employment — we end an assignment; the agency remains their employer and may place them elsewhere tomorrow. And access removal is the item that gets forgotten: an account that stays live after someone leaves is the most common audit finding at companies our size, so send that email on the last day rather than when you get to it.

Converting to an Employee

Sometimes an assignment makes it obvious that the work is really a job and the person is really the right hire. Converting is normal and we do it regularly.

The conversion fee. The agency found the person, so they are owed a fee when we hire them. The fee falls the longer the assignment has run:

Time on assignment when they start as an employee	Fee
First 90 days	20% of first-year base salary
Days 91–180	10%
After 180 days	No fee

The fee is calculated on base salary only — bonus, overtime and benefits are excluded. It comes out of the hiring department's budget, so factor it in before you start the conversation.

How to do it

- 1. Talk to HR first**, before you say anything to the worker. HR checks the agency agreement, confirms the fee and opens the conversation with the agency.
- 2. HR notifies the agency.** They are expecting this; it is a normal part of their business model and the fee is what makes it work.
- 3. Run a proper hiring process.** A conversion is still a hire — a defined role, an agreed salary, an offer. Being on assignment does not skip the steps, though it does mean you already know the answer to most of the questions.
- 4. Agree a start date** that gives the agency reasonable notice, normally two weeks.
- 5. The assignment closes in Beeline** the day before employment starts, and HR converts the BambooHR record rather than creating a second one.

Do not discuss a permanent role with a contingent worker before HR has spoken to the agency. It puts the person in an awkward position, it can breach our agency agreement, and if it falls through you have made their current assignment untenable.

If the agency's fee is the obstacle, say so to HR rather than waiting out the clock. Waiting until day 181 to avoid a fee is visible, it damages an agency relationship we depend on, and it usually costs more in lost time than the fee.

The other direction. If the classification review at twelve months says this is really a job but you do not want to hire, the assignment should end rather than roll on indefinitely. Talk to HR about the options.

Agency Invoices

You approve timesheets; you do not approve agency invoices. The approval you already gave on the timesheet is the authorisation to pay, and the invoice follows automatically.

How it works

1. You approve the week's timesheets by 5 p.m. Monday.
2. Beeline generates the invoice from the approved hours and the agreed bill rate.
3. Finance receives a single consolidated invoice per agency each week.
4. Finance pays on our standard terms, normally 30 days.

There is no separate invoice approval step and no purchase order to chase for hourly work. This is the main reason timesheet approval matters: it is the only control point in the chain.

Corrections. If an error is spotted after approval — wrong hours, wrong rate, overtime that should not have been there — the agency raises a credit note in Beeline. You approve it the same way you approved the timesheet, and it is netted off the next invoice. Tell HR if a correction is for anything other than a straightforward mistake.

Rate changes. The bill rate is fixed for the assignment unless HR agrees otherwise. If an invoice shows a rate you do not recognise, do not approve the next timesheet — email hr@helvia.ai and finance@helvia.ai.

Things that are not billable to us

- interview and sourcing time — the agency absorbs that
- the worker's onboarding administration or their background check
- travel to and from their normal place of work
- any equipment we did not agree to in advance

Budget tracking. Beeline shows committed and actual spend against each assignment under Reports → Assignment Spend. Check it before you extend — the most common surprise is an assignment that quietly ran more hours per week than planned.

Queries about payment timing or a specific invoice go to finance@helvia.ai. Queries about the rate or the agreement go to hr@helvia.ai.